

GETTING HANDS ON WITH WEARABLES

Creating apps for wearables is much easier than you think.

In the previous chapter after introducing you to the host of devices available in the wearables space, it's now time to get down to some DIY. Most often wearable devices work in sync with your smartphone. The smartphones host the main application and the wearables serve as an extension giving you timely information via notifications. They even let you launch simple applications to do simple tasks. A recent Google study found that we check our phones over 150 times a day and most of the time the purpose is to get just quick information. But in doing so we often end up getting distracted by those shiny apps. After a while you begin to wonder where all that time went. The solution to this time-sapping blackhole is Wearables. Therefore the apps that you eventually design should follow that same guiding philosophy.

Let's first talk about developing applications for Android smartwatches. Ideally you need an Android phone running Android 4.3 or later, and a compatible Android wearable smartwatch paired with the phone. If you don't have one of those prerequisites – and we're pretty sure it's the watch